

RENTAL SYSTEM

What runs today, what it cannot yet do, and the five steps that close the gap — in the order they have to be built.

STEP 01 • DELIVERED

RUNNING TODAY

The pickup side of a rental is fully digital. A customer can be handed a car and sign for it at the kerb, on a phone, with everything the contract needs captured at that moment.

BOOKING ENQUIRY

A complete enquiry goes from the website straight to WhatsApp.

PICKUP CONTRACT

Filled in and signed on a phone or tablet at handover.

IDENTITY ON FILE

ID and driving licence photographed front and back, with a portrait of the driver.

CONDITION RECORD

Mileage, fuel level, existing damage and photographs of the car as handed over.

TERMS ACCEPTANCE

The GTC are shown in the customer's own language and must be accepted before signing.

SIGNATURE

Signed on screen and reproduced on the contract.

CONTRACT DOCUMENT

Generated instantly and emailed to the customer, the office and the archive.

PAYMENT LINK

Carried in the contract email and in the site footer, so a customer can pay from either.

WHERE IT STOPS

Everything above ends with an email. Nothing is kept. Once a contract has been sent, the system has no memory of it — no record that the rental exists, which car is out, when it is due back, or whether this customer has rented before.

That is why the four things you asked for cannot be built on top of what exists. A reminder cannot be sent about a rental that was never written down. A dashboard cannot report on records that are not there. A tracked car cannot be matched to a driver without a rental to match it to.

Every step that follows begins by fixing that one thing.

STEPS 02 - 06

WHAT WE PROPOSE

01

DIGITAL PICKUP CONTRACT

DELIVERED

Live and in use. Everything listed on the previous page.

02

RENTAL RECORDS

START HERE

WHAT CHANGES – every rental is written down: who took the car, which car, from when until when, at what price and what deposit. The contract you already sign creates the record by itself. Nobody types anything twice.

WHY IT MATTERS – a speed camera fine arriving three months later names a car, not a driver. With records behind it, the person driving that car at that exact minute is found immediately. Today it is a search through old email.

03

RENEWAL AND RETURN REMINDERS

WHAT CHANGES – twenty-four hours before a rental ends, the customer is emailed automatically. Two choices: confirm the car comes back tomorrow, or extend the rental and pay for it there and then, by TWINT or card. The office is told which they chose.

WHY IT MATTERS – renters stop being chased by telephone. An extension becomes something the customer decides and pays for on their own, at the moment they realise they need it.

04

DIGITAL RETURN PROTOCOL

WHAT CHANGES – the return is recorded the way the handover already is: mileage, fuel, any new damage, photographs and a signature. The customer receives a closing document and the car is marked free.

WHY IT MATTERS – a damage or fuel dispute is settled against the record taken at handover instead of from memory. The photographs you already take at pickup finally have something to be compared against.

05

OFFICE DASHBOARD

WHAT CHANGES – one screen for the office: which cars are out and which are free, which rentals end this week, who has paid and who has not, and what each car has earned.

WHY IT MATTERS – the questions you answer today by reading back through email are answered at a glance.

06

VEHICLE TRACKING

WHAT CHANGES – trackers fitted to the cars report to the system, so each vehicle's position and mileage sit next to its rental record.

WHY IT MATTERS – you can see where a car is, and the mileage at return is read from the vehicle rather than typed in by hand.

Depends on the tracking hardware being fitted. Scheduled after the steps above, and the system is prepared for it from step 02 so that adding it later changes nothing already built.

WHY THIS ORDER

The order is not a preference. Each step needs the one above it to exist first.

Reminders need rentals with an end date to remind anyone about. A return protocol needs a rental to close. Reports need something to report on, which only steps 02 to 04 produce. And a tracked car only becomes useful once it can be tied to the person renting it.

Step 02 is the smallest of the five and the only one that unlocks the other four. It is also useful on its own, from the day it is finished: the traffic fine lookup works as soon as rentals are being recorded, before anything else is built. That is where we would start.

WHAT WE NEED FROM YOU

Three things only you can answer. None of them is technical.

■ Does your payment link already accept TWINT?

Open your existing SumUp payment link on a phone and tell us whether TWINT appears as a way to pay. If it does, renewals can be paid by TWINT from the first day and no new payment provider is needed.

■ How long should identity documents be kept?

Once photographs of ID and driving licences are stored rather than only emailed, they need a fixed period after which they are deleted automatically. Tell us the period you are comfortable with and deletion is built in from the start rather than added later.

■ How should deposits be handled?

Today the deposit is written on the contract but not collected through the system. Should it stay a note on the contract, or should the system take the deposit and return it when the car comes back?

The first question is enough to begin with. Step 02 does not depend on the other two — but both are far cheaper to decide now than to change once rentals are being recorded.